

Milestone 4 Detailed Description

User Test, Med-fi prototype

In this milestone, you'll execute the test plan you created in Milestone 3. Based on the problems you find with your user test, you'll improve your design and create a medium fidelity (med-fi) prototype using **Figma** or any alternative.

<i>Step</i>	<i>Activities</i>	<i>Output</i>
Conduct user test & analyze results	• Recruit participants • Conduct test sessions • Review notes and recordings • Identify critical incidents • Identify usability issues • Identify other UX issues (usefulness, desirability, additional needs/requirements) • Prioritize usability issues • Recommend solutions • Write report	Findings to be listed in the presentation (limit to 1 – 3 slides)
Create med-fi prototype	• Brainstorm & draft solutions • Select & refine solutions • Widen task focus (beyond key tasks) • Choose scenarios, create dummy data • Create med-fi prototype screens (complete, no placeholder text)	Prototype link shared in the presentation AND Prototype link shared in private comments when you submit your presentation

Activity Descriptions

Activity 1: Conduct User Test and Analyze Results

Step	Activities	Output
Conduct user test & analyze results	• Recruit participants • Conduct test sessions • Review notes and recordings • Identify critical incidents • Identify usability issues • Identify other UX issues (usefulness, desirability, additional needs/ requirements) • Prioritize usability issues • Recommend solutions • Write report	Findings to be listed in the presentation (limit to 1 – 3 slides)

Following the process you learned in “Evaluating Designs with Users,” conduct your user test and analyze the results to find and prioritize problems to be fixed. Be sure to use this opportunity to reflect on your earlier assumptions about your users, their needs, and how well your design approach will work for your users.

Activity 2: Create Med-fi Prototype

Step	Activities	Output
Create med-fi prototype	• Brainstorm & draft solutions • Select & refine solutions • Widen task focus (beyond key tasks) • Choose scenarios, create dummy data • Create med-fi prototype screens (complete, no placeholder text)	Prototype link shared in the presentation AND Prototype link shared in private comments when you submit your presentation

In addition to generating recommendations for fixes, though, you’ll need to actually make the fixes to your design. For this, you should do some focused, small-scale sketching and ideation to explore different ways to address the problems you found through your test. Some fixes will be simple: renaming a button or changing the layout of some widgets. Some fixes may be much bigger, however, ranging from a redesigned navigation scheme, to adding or removing steps for particular tasks, to splitting or merging screens, to identifying flaws in basic assumptions about your users, their tasks, and the viability of your design approach. Good thing you didn’t invest too much effort in creating that first prototype! Whatever the changes, sketch them out first, so that you can rapidly explore different possible solutions before taking the next step, which will involve a more substantial commitment to the details of your design.

Some problems you identify, or the fixes that they would require, may be too large or ambitious for you

to take on within the timeframe of this project. In the real world, this is often the case. If you encounter such a situation, you need to determine if the change is *essential* to delivering a product that meets user needs, or is a “nice-to-have.” If the change is essential, it may be that there is a suboptimal fix that is faster and cheaper but addresses the most significant aspects of the problem. In many cases, more significant fixes are moved to the bottom of the priority list in order to ensure that more manageable (but still important) fixes are able to be made. These are all decisions you’ll need to work out when revising your design, and you will need to use your best judgment and your knowledge of your users, their needs, and what will work for them to guide you.

In addition to improving your design, you should also expand the scope of your prototype. While your low-fi prototype focused on at least 5 to 6 key tasks, at this point you should add support for another 2-3 tasks. You may have identified additional tasks that users need to do, that you either left out of the first prototype due to scope, or that you have identified through subsequent research and design activities. If there are no additional key tasks (i.e., tasks that most users will need to accomplish in order to experience success with your design and find it valuable), you can focus on niche tasks (things that only some users will want/need to do), or configuration/ maintenance tasks such as changing settings, creating accounts, logging in, retrieving lost passwords, etc.

Once you’ve polished up your design in draft (could be sketches), it’s time to build a medium-fidelity (med-fi) prototype. While this is not substantially different from the wireframes and prototype you’ve built before, your med-fi prototype should start to address design details that you previously ignored. For example, you should be conscious of the particular platform(s) you’ll be targeting, and choose appropriate design templates. Be sure that your screen mockups are the correct size, and that the elements within the screens are sized and positioned as you think they should be. Be sure to use consistent language, task flows, layouts, etc. on different screens where appropriate. While your design should be more polished and detailed than your low-fi prototype was, it should still be a bit rough, using simple, basic fonts and colors and avoiding snazzy graphics or animations. You still have a couple of iterations to go before delivering your “final” prototype, so you don’t want to spend too much time or effort making this one perfect.

Your med-fi prototype should be built using a digital prototyping tool. There are a lot of options for such tools, and we will leave it up to you to choose one that suits you. Given the nature of this course, it is strongly advised that you choose a prototyping tool that makes it easy to share your interactive prototype via the web. This will expand your options for the final user test.

Your prototype must be interactive and shareable.

Milestone Deliverables

Produce a presentation (.ppt) with two clearly marked sections: User Test Report and Med-fi Prototype.

Section 1: User Test Report

Include your findings in 1 to 3 slides.

Section 2: Med-Fi Prototype

Following are the deliverables:

1. Share the prototype link shared in the presentation AND in the private comment when you submit your presentation in the Google Classroom

2. Include all major task flows using scaled down images in the presentation
3. Create a video of the prototype and share the link it's link as a private comment when you submit your presentation in the Google Classroom

Submission Instructions

Please submit a .ppt file with the name format : *HCI-Spring2026-Milestone04-YourTeamName.ppt*

Share the link of your prototype and the video of the prototype in the private comment when you upload your presentation.

Note: Only the placeholders in red will be replaced with your respective ones.

